

1.1 Integrated Development Environments

If you're building applications on complex platforms like C++, Java or .net, you *could* just use Notepad, but to get your work done faster, you'll need an IDE.

1.1.1 Microsoft Visual Studio Express Editions

In the spirit of encouraging budding developers, Microsoft now releases its immensely powerful Visual Studio IDE free of cost as Visual Studio Express Editions, with the difference that instead of one suite for all platforms, you have to download a separate Express Edition for each language you want to use. This month, you'll find Visual C# Express Edition (we'll call it VCS now) on our DVD.



Nothing beats VCS if you're a .net programmer

If you're new to C#, you couldn't ask for anything more. From the "starter kit" to the extensive documentation online and IntelliSense—the code-completion engine—you'll rarely, if ever, find yourself stuck in a bind. The default install comes with two starter kits—Screensaver and Movie



Fiddle with the starter applications to see what you can create

Collection. They're fully-functional as is, so you can study the code for your own reference—it's very well documented—or modify it to create your own customised application. Let's mess with the Screensaver starter kit, for instance.